

THE DIRTY Dozen

Developed countries have systematically worked to undermine the global climate regulation regime

 USA Barack Obama CO₂ EMISSIONS 5,902* RANK 2** PER CAPITA EMISSIONS 19.78*** Refused to ratify Kyoto Protocol; has blocked all efforts at Copenhagen, now offers meagre cuts.	 AUSTRALIA Kevin Rudd CO₂ EMISSIONS 417 RANK 16 PER CAPITA EMISSIONS 20.58 Ratified the Protocol only in 2007; since then has worked to undermine it and wants a new treaty.	 JAPAN Yukio Hatoyama CO₂ EMISSIONS 1,246 RANK 5 PER CAPITA EMISSIONS 9.78 Failed to meet 1990 commitments and was a foot-dragger till Hatoyama said 25% cuts in emissions.	 CANADA Stephen Harper CO₂ EMISSIONS 614 RANK 7 PER CAPITA EMISSIONS 18.81 Instead of cutting emissions, they increased by 30% since 1990, now wants to scuttle Kyoto.	 FRANCE Nicolas Sarkozy CO₂ EMISSIONS 417 RANK 15 PER CAPITA EMISSIONS 6.60 Pushing for trade sanctions against developing countries who don't fall in line on emission cuts.	 GERMANY Angela Merkel CO₂ EMISSIONS 857 RANK 6 PER CAPITA EMISSIONS 10.40 Failed to pull its weight and convince US not to be a deal-breaker; emissions have started rising.
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Source: Union of Concerned Scientists *million metric tonnes of CO₂ **based on total emissions ***tonnes per capita ☆China and India are in green because of rapid growth

enthusiasm, saying: "There are moments in history where the world can choose to go down different paths. This is one such defining moment: We can choose to go down the road towards green prosperity and a more sustainable future. Or we can choose a pathway to stalemate and do nothing about climate change leaving an enormous bill for our children and grandchildren to pay. It really isn't that hard a choice."

Tragically, nobody seemed to be listening very hard. Copenhagen was to be the culmination of negotiations spanning three years that should have come out with a blueprint to save the earth. Instead, Hedegaard and others now shamefacedly define it as "the beginning of the process and not the end". Simply put, unless the 192 leaders pull a rabbit out of their collective hat on December 18, the summit is likely to end with a watered-down political agreement that would read like a statement of intent rather than any enforceable action. In short, a lot of hot air that the planet could well do without.

Meanwhile, the summit has already become the butt of jokes on late night comedy sitcoms in the US. On NBC, Jimmy Fallon asked his viewers: "Hey, are you guys excited about the U.N. Climate Change Conference in Copenhagen? Yeah! Starting today, President Obama said the U.S. can reduce carbon emissions by 17 per cent by the year 2020. Then he was like, 'Of course, by then, I'll be out of office, so I can promise anything I want. By 2020, a free Xbox for every man, woman and child. By 2040, a Megan Fox clone for every dude. Not my problem, call President Timberlake.'" Jay Leno joked, "They say if the warming trend continues, by 2015 Hillary Clinton might actually thaw out."

Copenhagen in many ways was doomed from the start. It was to be the summit in which industrialised countries that form the so-called Annex 1 nations under the Kyoto

